THE HARVEST PATH

Educator's Guide

Sefirat HaOmer — A Collaborative Journey from Passover to Shavuot

Pluralistic Jewish Education · Grades 3–7 · 11 Modules · 49 Days

סְפִירַת הָעֹמֶר

חֶסֶד	גְּבוּרָה	תִּפְאֶרֶת	נֶצַח	הוֹד	יְסוֹד	מַלְכוּת
Chesed	Gevurah	Tiferet	Netzach	Hod	Yesod	Malchut

Interactive Program: https://doxwho.github.io/TheOmer/

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This guide is the companion document to **The Harvest Path** — an interactive digital program for teaching Sefirat HaOmer to students in Grades 3–7. The program runs in any web browser, designed for classroom use on a shared screen (computer projected on a TV or smartboard).

`Program URL: https://doxwho.github.io/TheOmer/`

PROGRAM PHILOSOPHY

• **Experience before explanation:** Each module leads with a striking quote, then teaching, then discussion, then a game.

• **Age differentiation:** Discussion prompts have Grades 3–5 and Grades 6–7 versions. Set Grade Band in Settings.

• **Collaborative scoring:** The point system is class-wide, not individual — the score reflects the group's journey.

• **Hebrew literacy as a byproduct:** Hebrew terms, blessings, and sources are embedded in content, not as separate vocabulary.

• **Jewish practice context:** Accessible across Jewish traditions. Educator-only notes appear only in this guide.

• **The Journey arc:** Passover → Seven Sefirot → Yom HaShoah → Yom Hazikaron → Yom Ha'atzmaut → Lag BaOmer → Shavuot.

TYPICAL SESSION STRUCTURE (45–60 min)

Phase	Time	Description
Opening Check-in	3–5 min	Session Opener panel: Did you practice last week's Middah? What happened?
Learning	8–10 min	Read the weekly quote and learning text. Discuss 'Why This Matters Today.'
Sefirot Map	3–5 min	Open the Sefirot Explainer. Remind students where they are in the 49-day journey.
Omer Blessing	2–3 min	Open Omer Blessing panel. Recite together if it is after nightfall.
Middah	5 min	Open the Middah panel. Share this week's practice challenge.
Discussion	8–12 min	Display the discussion question. Pair-share, then whole class.
Challenge / Game	10–15 min	Open the Challenge tab. Follow game instructions in this guide.
Transition	2–3 min	Click NEXT PHASE to advance. Preview next week's theme.

TECHNOLOGY SETUP

• **Platform:** Single HTML file at https://doxwho.github.io/TheOmer/. Open in Chrome or Firefox.

• **Display:** Designed for 1080p TV or smartboard. Three-column grid optimized for projection.

• **Student roster:** Enter names in Settings before the first session. The random picker uses this list in all games.

- **Grade Band:** Set in Settings → Grade Band. Controls which discussion prompts appear.
- **Timer:** Default 30 minutes, adjustable in Settings. Does not auto-advance modules.
- **Scoring:** Session-only; resets on page reload. Not stored between sessions.
- **Keyboard:** Press Escape to close any modal. Designed for TV remote navigation.

THE SEFIROT MAP

Seven Qualities for Seven Weeks — Quick Reference for Facilitators

The seven lower Sefirot are the qualities of character through which the Omer journey is structured. Each week focuses on one Sefirah, building toward the synthesis of all seven in Malchut (Week 7).

Wk	Sefirah	Hebrew	Meaning	Days	Key Teaching
W1	**Chesed**	**חֶסֶד**	Loving-Kindness	1–7	Giving from the heart without limits
W2	**Gevurah**	**גְּבוּרָה**	Discipline & Strength	8–14	Strength through boundaries
W3	**Tiferet**	**תִּפְאֶרֶת**	Balance & Compassion	15–21	Holding truth and kindness together
W4	**Netzach**	**נֶצַח**	Endurance	22–28	Grit — keeping going when it is hard
W5	**Hod**	**הוֹד**	Gratitude & Humility	35–41	Stepping back to say thank you
W6	**Yesod**	**יְסוֹד**	Foundation	42–48	Being someone others can rely on
W7	**Malchut**	**מַלְכוּת**	Leadership & Presence	49	The harvest of all seven weeks
D12	**Yom HaShoah**	יוֹם הַשּׁוֹאָה	Holocaust & Heroism Remembrance	12	Zachor — active memory as a commandment
D28	**Yom Hazikaron**	יוֹם הַזִּכָּרוֹן	Israel Memorial Day	28	Collective grief and national identity
D29	**Yom Ha'atzmaut**	יוֹם הָעַצְמָאוּת	Israel Independence Day	29	The Jewish State and diaspora identity
D33	**Lag BaOmer**	לַג בָּעֹמֶר	The Hidden Light	33	Hidden wisdom and mystical tradition

THE OMER BLESSING & COUNT

For daily recitation after nightfall throughout the 49-day period

THE OMER BLESSING

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ עַל סְפִירַת הָעֹמֶר.

Baruch Atah Adonai, Eloheinu Melech ha-olam, asher kid'shanu b'mitzvotav v'tzivanu al sefirat ha-omer.

Blessed are You, Eternal our God, Sovereign of the universe, who has sanctified us with Your commandments and commanded us concerning the counting of the Omer.

Recited each night after nightfall, before announcing the day count.

DAY COUNTS FOR EACH MODULE

The blessing is followed by the day count. Below are the Hebrew and English counts for the first day of each program module.

Module	Day	Hebrew Count	English Count
Week 1 — Chesed	**1**	הַיּוֹם יוֹם אֶחָד לָעֹמֶר	Today is one day of the Omer.
Week 2 — Gevurah	**8**	הַיּוֹם שְׁמוֹנָה יָמִים, שֶׁהֵם שָׁבוּעַ אֶחָד וְיוֹם אֶחָד לָעֹמֶר	Today is eight days, which is one week and one day of the Omer.
Day 12 — Yom HaShoah	**12**	הַיּוֹם שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם שָׁבוּעַ אֶחָד וַחֲמִשָּׁה יָמִים לָעֹמֶר	Today is twelve days, which is one week and five days of the Omer.
Week 3 — Tiferet	**15**	הַיּוֹם חֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם שְׁנֵי שָׁבוּעוֹת וְיוֹם אֶחָד לָעֹמֶר	Today is fifteen days, which is two weeks and one day of the Omer.
Week 4 — Netzach	**22**	הַיּוֹם שְׁנַיִם וְעֶשְׂרִים יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם שְׁלֹשָׁה שָׁבוּעוֹת וְיוֹם אֶחָד לָעֹמֶר	Today is twenty-two days, which is three weeks and one day of the Omer.
Day 28 — Yom Hazikaron	**28**	הַיּוֹם שְׁמוֹנָה וְעֶשְׂרִים יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם אַרְבָּעָה שָׁבוּעוֹת לָעֹמֶר	Today is twenty-eight days, which is four weeks of the Omer.

Module	Day	Hebrew Count	English Count
Day 29 — Yom Ha'atzmaut	**29**	הַיּוֹם תִּשְׁעָה וְעֶשְׂרִים יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם אַרְבָּעָה שָׁבוּעוֹת וְיוֹם אֶחָד לָעֹמֶר	Today is twenty-nine days, which is four weeks and one day of the Omer.
Day 33 — Lag BaOmer	**33**	הַיּוֹם שְׁלֹשָׁה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם אַרְבָּעָה שָׁבוּעוֹת וַחֲמִשָּׁה יָמִים לָעֹמֶר	Today is thirty-three days, which is four weeks and five days of the Omer.
Week 5 — Hod	**35**	הַיּוֹם חֲמִשָּׁה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם חֲמִשָּׁה שָׁבוּעוֹת לָעֹמֶר	Today is thirty-five days, which is five weeks of the Omer.
Week 6 — Yesod	**42**	הַיּוֹם שְׁנַיִם וְאַרְבָּעִים יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם שִׁשָּׁה שָׁבוּעוֹת לָעֹמֶר	Today is forty-two days, which is six weeks of the Omer.
Week 7 — Malchut	**49**	הַיּוֹם תִּשְׁעָה וְאַרְבָּעִים יוֹם, שֶׁהֵם שִׁבְעָה שָׁבוּעוֹת לָעֹמֶר	Today is forty-nine days, which is seven weeks of the Omer.

WEEK 1 | Omer Days: 1–7

Loving-Kindness: Giving from the heart without expectation of return.

חֶסֶד

Chesed

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Loving-Kindness: Giving from the heart without expectation of return.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

In a world that often rewards taking over giving, Chesed is a countercultural act. This week, every act of giving without expecting something back is a small revolution.

LEARNING TEXT

Chesed is expansive love. Abraham's tent had four doors so he could see guests coming from any direction. Kindness is not just being nice — it is actively looking for opportunities to give.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

עוֹלָם חֶסֶד יִבָּנֶה

Olam chesed yibaneh

The world is built on kindness. (Psalm 89:3)

THIS WEEK'S MIDDAH · ■■■■■■

Chesed — Loving-Kindness

חֶסֶד

Practice: Perform one unexpected act of kindness each day — for a friend, a family member, or a stranger. Write it down in your Omer journal.

Verse: *Love your neighbor as yourself. (Leviticus 19:18)*

גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים

Mitzvah Connection: Acts of loving-kindness (Gemilut Chasadim) — one of the three pillars on which the world stands.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"If Chesed is 'giving without limits,' is there ever a time where giving too much might be a problem?"
Grades 3–5	"Can you think of a time you did something kind for someone without being asked? How did that feel?"
Grades 6–7	"What's the difference between kindness and enabling?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: CHESED SECRET CHARADES

Format: Charades (5 rounds)

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Press 'New Guessers' to randomly select 3 students. Press 'Reveal' to show the actor their task privately. Guessers identify the act of kindness. Score 25 points per correct round.

Content / Tasks:

• Helping carry groceries

• Sharing an umbrella

• Comforting a friend

• Donating a toy

• Planting a tree

■ What to Look For:

Notice which students lean into the act versus merely 'perform' it. Debrief: 'Was your character doing Chesed for themselves or the other person?'

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

The Session Opener for Week 1 includes three foundational questions to orient students to the whole Omer journey: What is a mitzvah? What would you commit to for 49 days? What is the difference between obligation and desire? Allow 5–8 minutes before moving to the Learning tab. The Jewish Practice Context panel explains that the Omer is counted Saturday nights after Havdalah and each weekday evening after nightfall.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Chesed	חֶסֶד	*kheh-SED*	Loving-kindness; unconditional love in action

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Gemilut Chasadim	גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים	*geh-mee-LOOT khah-sah-DEEM*	Acts of loving-kindness done with one's whole self
Sefirah	סְפִירָה	*seh-fee-RAH*	A sphere or emanation; one of the 10 divine qualities in Kabbalah
Sefirot	סְפִירוֹת	*seh-fee-ROTE*	Plural of Sefirah
Sefirat HaOmer	סְפִירַת הָעֹמֶר	*seh-fee-RAT ha-OH-mer*	The 49-day counting period between Passover and Shavuot
Middah	מִדָּה	*mee-DAH*	A quality of character; a spiritual trait to cultivate
Omer	עֹמֶר	*OH-mer*	An ancient barley measure; the 49-day counting period

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

BimBam: What is Chesed? (Video)	bimbam.com/videos/what-is-chesed/
My Jewish Learning: Gemilut Chasadim	myjewishlearning.com/article/gemilut-hasadim-acts-of-loving-kindness/
Sefaria: Leviticus 19:18	sefaria.org/Leviticus.19.18
Chabad.org: Chesed	chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/979459/jewish/Chesed.htm
The iCenter: Teaching the Omer	theicenter.org/

WEEK 2 | Omer Days: 8–14

Strength through boundaries: the discipline to hold standards and say 'no' with integrity.

גְּבוּרָה

Gevurah

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Strength through boundaries: the discipline to hold standards and say 'no' with integrity.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

Social media is designed to make saying 'yes' easy and saying 'no' almost impossible. Gevurah gives us the tools to set boundaries without guilt.

LEARNING TEXT

Gevurah is 'Strength' through boundaries. Just as a dam holds back water to create power, Gevurah focuses our energy. It is the strength to say 'No' to ourselves.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

אֵיזֶהוּ גִּבּוֹר? הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ

Eizehu gibor? Ha-kovesh et yitzro

Who is strong? One who masters their own impulses. (Pirkei Avot 4:1)

THIS WEEK'S MIDDAH · ■■■■■■

Gevurah — Boundaries & Discipline

גְּבוּרָה

Practice: Choose one thing this week to say 'no' to — something that pulls you away from your best self. This is not about restriction; it is about focus.

Verse: *Who is strong? One who masters their impulses. (Pirkei Avot 4:1)*

Mitzvah Connection: Lo Titgodedu — not following the crowd when the crowd is wrong — requires inner strength. Gevurah gives us the courage to hold our own standards.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"Why do we need rules? If there were no rules in soccer or chess, would the game still be fun?"
Grades 3–5	"What's a rule at home or school that you think is actually fair? Why does it exist?"
Grades 6–7	"What's the difference between a rule that limits you and one that actually sets you free?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: THE GEVURAH SHIELD

Format: Sorting Game (5 items)

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Students see 5 behaviors on screen. Clicking a Boundary behavior adds to the shield (+10 pts). Clicking a Chaos behavior flashes red. Goal: identify all 3 Boundary behaviors.

Content / Tasks:

• Finishing homework first (Boundary +10 pts)

• Interrupting people (Chaos — red flash)

• Setting a screen time limit (Boundary)

• Candy for breakfast (Chaos)

• Listening to instructions (Boundary)

■ What to Look For:

Students who want to defend 'chaos' choices: this is the teaching moment. Gevurah is about discernment, not rigid restriction.

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

The 'Lo Titgodedu' mitzvah reference (not following the crowd when it is wrong) is sophisticated for older students. For Grades 3–5, simplify to: 'Gevurah means having the courage to do the right thing even when your friends aren't.'

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Gevurah	גְּבוּרָה	*geh-voo-RAH*	Strength; discipline; the power of boundaries
Yetzer HaTov	יֵצֶר הַטּוֹב	*YAY-tzer ha-TOVE*	Good impulse — one of two internal drives in Jewish psychology
Yetzer HaRa	יֵצֶר הָרָע	*YAY-tzer ha-RAH*	Harmful impulse — one of two internal drives in Jewish psychology
Lo Titgodedu	לֹא תִתְגֹּדְדוּ	*lo tit-go-DEH-doo*	Do not follow the crowd (Deuteronomy 14:1)

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

Sefaria: Pirkei Avot 4:1	`sefaria.org/Pirkei_Avot.4.1`
Chabad.org: Gevurah	`chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/979460/jewish/Gevurah.htm`
My Jewish Learning: Counting the Omer	`myjewishlearning.com/article/counting-the-omer/`

WEEK 3 | Omer Days: 15–21

Beautiful balance: compassion that holds kindness and strength together.

תִּפְאֶרֶת

Tiferet

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Beautiful balance: compassion that holds kindness and strength together.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

We live in a culture of extremes: all or nothing, us or them. Tiferet teaches that holding two truths at once — being honest AND kind — is not weakness. It is wisdom.

LEARNING TEXT

Tiferet is the 'Beautiful Balance.' It sits at the heart of the Sefirot tree, combining the unlimited giving of Chesed with the focused discipline of Gevurah to create Rachamim — Compassion.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

צֶ֣דֶק וּמִשְׁפָּ֗ט מְכוֹן֙ כִּסְאֶ֔ךָ חֶ֥סֶד וֶאֱמֶ֖ת יְקַדְּמ֣וּ פָנֶֽיךָ׃

Chesed ve-emet yekad'mu fanekha

Kindness and truth go before You. (Psalm 89:15)

THIS WEEK'S MIDDAH · ■■■■■■

תִּפְאֶרֶת

Tiferet — Balance & Compassion

Practice: Each day, find one moment to hold two truths at once: be honest AND be kind.

Verse: *Truth and kindness go before You. (Psalm 89:15)*

Mitzvah Connection: Dan l'chaf zechut — judging others favorably — is the practice of Tiferet. Before assuming the worst, pause and imagine the most generous explanation.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"Think of a time you were both firm (Gevurah) AND kind (Chesed) at the same time."
Grades 3–5	"Have you ever told a friend the truth even though it was hard? What happened?"
Grades 6–7	"Is it possible to be honest with someone while also being compassionate? What's the hardest part?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: HARMONY MATCH-UP

Format: Matching Game (3 pairs)

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Three actions appear on the left; three Sefirot names on the right. Click an action then the matching Sefirah (+25 pts each). Wrong match = red flash. Complete all 3 pairs.

Content / Tasks:

• "Giving an anonymous gift" → Chesed

• "Finishing what you started even when it's hard" → Gevurah

• "Forgiving a friend's mistake" → Tiferet

■ What to Look For:

Students who hesitate on the Tiferet pairing are discovering that forgiveness requires both strength and love — that's precisely the point.

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

The Tiferet session is the first time students encounter the idea that the Sefirot interact — that Chesed and Gevurah are not opposites but complements. Use the matching game debrief to reinforce this: 'Why does forgiveness require both strength and love?'

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Tiferet	תִּפְאֶרֶת	*tif-EH-ret*	Beauty; balance; the heart of the Sefirot; compassion born of holding opposites
Rachamim	רַחֲמִים	*rah-khah-MEEM*	Compassion; deep mercy; related to 'rechem' (womb) — tenderness from the core
Dan l'chaf zechut	דָּן לְכַף זְכוּת	*dan le-KAF ze-KHOOT*	Judging others favorably; assuming the best possible interpretation

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

Sefaria: Psalm 89:15	sefaria.org/Psalms.89
Chabad.org: Tiferet	chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/979461/jewish/Tiferet.htm
My Jewish Learning: The Kabbalistic Tradition	myjewishlearning.com/article/the-kabbalistic-tradition/

WEEK 4 | Omer Days: 22–28

Endurance: grit, perseverance, and the Jewish refusal to give up.

נֶצַח

Netzach

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Endurance: grit, perseverance, and the Jewish refusal to give up.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

The Omer was counted by an agricultural people who knew you could not rush a harvest. In an age of instant everything, Netzach teaches that the most important things take time.

LEARNING TEXT

Netzach means 'Endurance' or 'Victory.' It is the grit to keep going when things get hard. Think of the marathon runner — not the fastest sprinter, but the one who finishes.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

נֵצַח יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא יְשַׁקֵּר

Netzach Yisrael lo yeshaker

The Endurance of Israel does not fail. (1 Samuel 15:29)

THIS WEEK'S MIDDAH · ■■■■■■

נֶצַח

Netzach — Perseverance

Practice: Start something small this week that you commit to doing every single day. Don't break the chain.

Verse: *The endurance of Israel does not fail. (1 Samuel 15:29)*

Mitzvah Connection: Talmud Torah — daily Torah learning — is the classic Jewish practice of Netzach. Even one minute of Torah study each day builds a spiritual foundation.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"What is something you worked on for a long time without giving up? What kept you going?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: ENDURANCE RELAY

Format: Pair Knowledge Challenge (4 rounds)

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Click 'Generate Pairs.' Partner A holds an uncomfortable-but-safe position. Partner B answers the Hebrew knowledge question. Click 'Show Hebrew' to reveal, 'Correct' to advance (+20 pts per round).

Content / Tasks:

• Name the 2 Shabbat commandments → [redacted] (Zachor v'Shamor)

• Name the 3 Patriarchs → [redacted], [redacted], [redacted]

• Name the 4 Matriarchs → [redacted], [redacted], [redacted], [redacted]

• Name the 5 Books of Torah → [redacted], [redacted], [redacted], [redacted], [redacted]

■ What to Look For:

The physicality is deliberate — the student holding the position is practicing Netzach in real time. Note who encourages their partner vs. who focuses only on their own answer.

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

Omer Mourning Period: In some communities, the Omer includes a period of semi-mourning — no live music or weddings. It honors Rabbi Akiva's 24,000 students who perished (Talmud, Yevamot 62b). Ask your rabbi what your community observes.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Netzach	נֶצַח	*NEH-tzach*	Endurance; victory; strength that persists over time
Talmud Torah	תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה	*tal-MOOD toe-RAH*	Torah study; the mitzvah of daily learning
Zachor / Shamor	זָכוֹר / שָׁמוֹר	*zah-KHOR / sha-MORE*	Remember / Keep — the two Shabbat commandments

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

Sefaria: 1 Samuel 15:29	sefaria.org/I_Samuel.15.29
Chabad.org: Netzach	chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/979462/jewish/Netzach.htm
My Jewish Learning: Counting the Omer	myjewishlearning.com/article/counting-the-omer/

DAY 12 | Omer Day: 12 (27 Nisan)

Zachor — Remember. Each person contains an entire world.

יוֹם הַשּׁוֹאָה

Yom HaShoah

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Zachor — Remember. Each person contains an entire world.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

Without memory, there is no future. Zachor — to remember — is not a passive act. It is a commandment that requires us to act: to name, to learn, to resist indifference.

LEARNING TEXT

Yom HaZikaron laShoah v'laGevurah is observed on the 27th of Nisan — the 12th day of the Omer — chosen to align with the Warsaw Ghetto Uprising. The fighters, led by 23-year-old Mordechai Anielewicz, held out for nearly a month. Yad Vashem has recovered the names of 4.8 million victims — the search for the remaining 1.2 million continues.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

כָּל הַמְאַבֵּד נֶפֶשׁ אַחַת מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, מַעֲלֶה עָלָיו הַכָּתוּב כְּאִלּוּ אִבֵּד עוֹלָם מָלֵא

Kol ha-meabed nefesh achat me-Yisrael...

Anyone who destroys a single soul from Israel, it is as if an entire world has been destroyed. (Talmud, Sanhedrin 37a)

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"The Talmud teaches that each person contains an entire world. When six million people were murdered, how many worlds were lost?"
Grades 3–5	"What does it mean to remember someone you never met? Why do we do it?"
Grades 6–7	"The Warsaw Ghetto fighters knew they could not win. They fought anyway. What is the difference between hope and defiance?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: HERITAGE MODULE: ZACHOR

Format: Three-Part Heritage Module

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Open the Heritage Module via 'OPEN HERITAGE MODULE.' Navigate Learning → Discussion → Challenge. The Candle Lighting panel lets students light a yellow memorial candle together. Click 'Mark as Observed — Zachor' (+50 pts).

Content / Tasks:

• Witness a Testimony: Watch a 5-min survivor testimony via USC Shoah Foundation IWitness (iwitness.usc.edu)

• Recover a Name: Search Yad Vashem Hall of Names for a name from your community

• Write a Zachor Pledge: A class commitment with a specific name and the word 'never'

■ What to Look For:

Allow silence. Do not rush through the testimony. Students who are visibly moved should be supported, not redirected. The goal is witness, not resolution.

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

Some students may have family connections to the Holocaust. Consider notifying parents before this session. Create space for personal reflection. The yellow memorial candle is chosen because of the yellow Star of David Jews were forced to wear. The 'Mark as Observed' button (rather than 'Mark Complete') is intentional — this module is a memorial to be observed, not a game to be completed.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Shoah	שׁוֹאָה	*sho-AH*	Holocaust; literally 'catastrophe' or 'destruction'

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Zachor	זָכוֹר	*zah-KHOR*	Remember — a commandment of active memory
Lo nishkach	לֹא נִשְׁכַּח	*lo nish-KAKH*	We will not forget
Yehi zikhram barukh	יְהִי זִכְרָם בָּרוּךְ	*yeh-HEE zikh-RAM bah-ROOKH*	May their memory be a blessing

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

Yad Vashem: Hall of Names	`collections.yadvashem.org/en/names`
Yad Vashem: Warsaw Ghetto Testimonies	`yadvashem.org/yv/en/exhibitions/warsaw_ghetto_testimonies/index.asp`
USC Shoah Foundation IWitness	`iwitness.usc.edu`
My Jewish Learning: Yom HaShoah	`myjewishlearning.com/article/yom-hashoah/`

DAY 28 | Omer Day: 28

Israel Memorial Day: honoring the fallen with collective silence.

יוֹם הַזִּכָּרוֹן

Yom Hazikaron

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Israel Memorial Day: honoring the fallen with collective silence.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

The siren forces everyone to stop at the same moment. This collective pause is unlike anything in most students' experience.

LEARNING TEXT

As of 2024, 24,213 Israeli soldiers and terror victims are commemorated. The memorial siren began in 1963. Natan Alterman's poem 'The Silver Platter' ([redacted], 1947) gave the day its defining image.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

אֵלֶּה אֶזְכְּרָה וְנַפְשִׁי עָלַי אֶשְׁפְּכָה

Eleh ezkerah ve-nafshi alai eshpecha

These I remember, and my soul pours itself out within me.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"What does it mean when an entire nation pauses together in silence? How is collective memory different from personal memory?"
Grades 3–5	"Have you ever been in a moment of silence? What was it for? What did it feel like?"
Grades 6–7	"How does knowing the price paid for Israel's existence change the way you think about being Jewish today?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: HERITAGE MODULE + SIREN PLAYER

Format: Heritage Module with Interactive Siren

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Open Heritage Module and navigate to Learning tab. Select Evening Siren (1 min) or Morning Siren (2 min). Ask all students to stand before pressing 'Sound the Siren.' Click 'Mark Module Complete' (+50 pts).

Content / Tasks:

• Write a Lone Soldier letter: lonesoldiercenter.com

• Read the Poem: 'The Silver Platter' by Natan Alterman — nli.org.il

• Research a Figure: Find a soldier's letter in the NLI digital archive

■ What to Look For:

Ask all students to stand during the Siren. Debrief: 'What went through your mind during those two minutes?'

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

Yom Hazikaron transitions immediately into Yom Ha'atzmaut at nightfall — from deepest mourning to highest celebration. This is one of the most profound transitions in the Jewish calendar. The Siren Player uses the Web Audio API (310–620 Hz sawtooth oscillator). Test audio before the session.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Yom Hazikaron	יוֹם הַזִּכָּרוֹן	*yom hah-zik-ah-RON*	Memorial Day; literally 'Day of Remembrance'
HaMegash HaKesef	הַמַּגָּשׁ הַכֶּסֶף	*ha-mah-GASH ha-KEH-sef*	'The Silver Platter' — Natan Alterman's 1947 poem
Chayal boded	חַיָּל בּוֹדֵד	*kha-YAL bo-DAYD*	Lone soldier — IDF soldier serving far from family

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

NLI: Yom Hazikaron Topic	nli.org.il/en/discover/israel-studies/yom-hazikaron
My Jewish Learning: Yom Hazikaron	myjewishlearning.com/article/yom-hazikaron/
Lone Soldier Center	lonesoldiercenter.com
Poetry Foundation: The Silver Platter (English)	poetryfoundation.org/poems/49910/the-silver-platter

DAY 29 | Omer Day: 29

Israel Independence Day: the establishment of the Jewish state and its ongoing meaning.

יוֹם הָעַצְמָאוּת

Yom Ha'atzmaut

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Israel Independence Day: the establishment of the Jewish state and its ongoing meaning.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

Israel's existence is not a historical footnote — it is the central geopolitical and spiritual reality of Jewish life in the modern era.

LEARNING TEXT

On May 14, 1948, David Ben-Gurion proclaimed the State of Israel. The Declaration uses 'Tzur Yisrael' (■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■■ — Rock of Israel) rather than 'God,' making it inclusively interpreted by secular and religious Jews alike.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

עוֹד לֹא אָבְדָה תִּקְוָתֵנוּ

Od lo avdah tikvatenu

Our hope is not yet lost. (Hatikvah — Israel's national anthem)

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"The drafters chose 'Tzur Yisrael' instead of 'God.' Why might a founding document choose ambiguity over clarity on religious questions?"
Grades 3–5	"What would you put in a declaration if you were starting a new community? What promises would you make?"
Grades 6–7	"Israel became a tech and agricultural leader despite constant security challenges. What does this say about Jewish values like tikkun olam and l'dor v'dor?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: HERITAGE MODULE: INDEPENDENCE

Format: Three-Part Heritage Module

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Open Heritage Module. Navigate Learning → Discussion → Challenge. Click 'Mark Module Complete' when finished (+50 pts).

Content / Tasks:

• Read the Declaration: Find the paragraph beginning 'The State of Israel will be open...'

• Israeli Innovation Hunt: Research one Israeli innovation (drip irrigation, PillCam, Waze, Mobileye)

• Connect with Israel: Find a Jewish teen org connecting diaspora Jews with Israeli peers (BBYO, USY, Hadassah Youth)

■ What to Look For:

The discussion about Tzur Yisrael often surprises students who assume Israel is 'religious.' This ambiguity was a founding act of inclusion — a key teaching moment.

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

Yom Ha'atzmaut is celebrated in many synagogues with Hallel and special prayers. For the Innovation Hunt: drip irrigation was developed by Simcha Blass and Kibbutz Hatzerim (Netafim) in the 1960s. Waze was acquired by Google in 2013 for $1.1 billion. Mobileye was acquired by Intel in 2017 for $15.3 billion.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Yom Ha'atzmaut	יוֹם הָעַצְמָאוּת	*yom hah-ahtz-mah-OOT*	Independence Day
Megillat Ha'atzmaut	מְגִילַת הָעַצְמָאוּת	*meh-ghee-LAT hah-ahtz-mah-OOT*	Declaration of Independence — 'Scroll of Independence'

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Tzur Yisrael	צוּר יִשְׂרָאֵל	*tzoor yis-rah-AEL*	'Rock of Israel' — used in the Declaration in place of God
Hatikvah	הַתִּקְוָה	*ha-tik-VAH*	The Hope — Israel's national anthem
L'dor v'dor	לְדוֹר וָדוֹר	*le-DOR vah-DOR*	From generation to generation

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

NLI: Declaration of Independence	nli.org.il/en/discover/israel-studies/declaration-of-independence
Knesset: Full text of Megillat Ha'atzmaut	knesset.gov.il/docs/eng/megilat_eng.htm
My Jewish Learning: Yom Ha'atzmaut	myjewishlearning.com/article/yom-haatzmaut-israels-independence-day/
The iCenter: Teaching Yom Ha'atzmaut	theicenter.org/resource/yom-haatzmaut/

DAY 33 | Omer Day: 33

The hidden light of Torah: celebrating Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai and the mystical tradition.

לג בָּעֹמֶר

Lag BaOmer

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

The hidden light of Torah: celebrating Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai and the mystical tradition.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

The Zohar teaches that there is always more beneath the surface — of a text, a person, a situation. In an age of surface-level reading, Lag BaOmer says: look deeper.

LEARNING TEXT

Rashbi was sentenced to death by Rome for criticizing their rule. He hid in a cave for 13 years, emerging transformed. During that time he authored the Zohar — a profound mystical commentary uncovering hidden spiritual layers.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת הָיְתָה בְּפִיהוּ

Torat emet haytah befihu

The Torah of truth was in his mouth. (Malachi 2:6)

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"Rashbi taught that the hidden meaning of Torah matters as much as its surface. Why does intention — the 'why' behind what we do — matter in a mitzvah?"
Grades 3–5	"Rabbi Shimon hid in a cave for 13 years and came out transformed. Has something hard you went through ever changed you in a good way?"
Grades 6–7	"Do you think there is a difference between following a rule and truly believing in it? When does intention change the action?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: BONFIRE TRIVIA

Format: Multiple Choice Quiz (4 questions)

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Questions appear one at a time with 3 multiple-choice options. Correct answer opens the modal with explanation (+25 pts). The GEMATRIA? button (orange) opens a side panel on Hebrew numerology. Wrong answer = red flash.

Content / Tasks:

• Q: What did Rashbi write? → The Zohar (+25 pts)

• Q: How many years did Rashbi hide? → 13 (+25 pts)

• Q: What number does 'Lag' equal in Gematria? → 33 (+25 pts)

• Q: Why do we observe semi-mourning during the Omer? → Students of Rabbi Akiva died (+25 pts)

■ What to Look For:

Use the Gematria button even when students get the answer right. 'Why 33 is Sacred' is a teaching opportunity about mystical numerology.

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

Lag BaOmer is a universal break in Omer mourning — appropriate to acknowledge as a moment of levity within a spiritually serious period. Bonfires are the traditional celebration (Rashbi's spiritual light outlasting Roman darkness). In Israel, Lag BaOmer is one of the most widely celebrated national-folk holidays.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Lag BaOmer	לַ֫ג בָּעֹמֶר	*lahg bah-OH-mer*	33rd day of the Omer — Lamed (30) + Gimmel (3) = 33

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Rashbi	רַשְׁבִּ"י	*RASH-bee*	Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai — 2nd century CE mystic and author of the Zohar
Zohar	זֹהַר	*ZO-har*	'Radiance' — the foundational text of Kabbalah
Gematria	גְּמַטְרִיָּה	*geh-mah-TREE-yah*	Hebrew numerology — each letter has a numerical value
PaRDeS	פַּרְדֵּס	*par-DEYS*	Four levels of Torah interpretation: Peshat, Remez, Derash, Sod

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

BimBam: Lag BaOmer Explained	bimbam.com/videos/lag-baomer/
Sefaria: The Zohar	sefaria.org/Zohar.1.1a.1
Chabad.org: Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai	chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/332564/jewish/Who-Was-Rabbi-Shimon-bar-Yochai.htm
My Jewish Learning: Lag BaOmer	myjewishlearning.com/article/lag-baomer/

WEEK 5 | Omer Days: 35–41

Gratitude and humility: stepping back to say 'thank you.'

הוֹד

Hod

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Gratitude and humility: stepping back to say 'thank you.'

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

Gratitude is increasingly recognized by psychology as one of the most reliable paths to wellbeing. Jewish tradition knew this thousands of years ago — Modeh Ani was the world's first daily gratitude practice.

LEARNING TEXT

Hod is 'Splendor' — expressed through humility and gratitude. It is the quality of stepping back to say 'Thank You,' recognizing that our gifts and achievements are not ours alone.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

מוֹדֶה אֲנִי לְפָנֶיךָ

Modeh ani lefanekha

I give thanks before You. (Morning Prayer — Modeh Ani)

THIS WEEK'S MIDDAH · ■■■■■■

Hod — Gratitude & Humility

הוֹד

Practice: Each morning, name three things you are grateful for before looking at your phone. Each night, thank one person who helped you that day.

Verse: *I give thanks before You. (Morning Prayer — Modeh Ani)*

הַכָּרַת הַטּוֹב

Mitzvah Connection: Hakarat HaTov — recognizing the good — means genuinely noticing that what we have is a gift.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"Is it harder to be a winner with humility, or a loser with grace? Which takes more strength?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: THE A–Z GRATITUDE GRID

Format: Collaborative Class Activity (26 letters)

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Click 'Call Student' to randomly select a student for each letter. Type their answer into the corresponding letter box. Complete all 26 letters, then advance (+100 pts). The Export button downloads the list as a text file.

Content / Tasks:

• For each letter A–Z, a student names something they're grateful for starting with that letter.

• Entries are typed into the grid and visible to the class on the shared screen.

• When all 26 letters are filled, click 'Complete Hod Journey' (+100 pts).

■ What to Look For:

Answers often deepen as the alphabet progresses — early letters are easy; X, Y, Z require creativity. That creative stretch is itself a Hod moment.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Hod	הוֹד	*HODE*	Splendor; gratitude; humble acknowledgment of gifts received
Hakarat HaTov	הַכָּרַת הַטּוֹב	*hah-kah-RAT ha-TOVE*	Recognizing the good; active gratitude
Modeh Ani	מוֹדֶה אֲנִי	*mo-DEH ah-NEE*	I give thanks — the first prayer said upon waking

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

Sefaria: Modeh Ani	`sefaria.org/Siddur_Ashkenaz,_Weekday,_Shacharit,_Preparatory_Prayers,_Modeh_Ani.1`
Chabad.org: Hod	`chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/979463/jewish/Hod.htm`
My Jewish Learning: Gratitude in Judaism	`myjewishlearning.com/article/gratitude-in-judaism/`

WEEK 6 | Omer Days: 42–48

Foundation and integrity: being someone others can truly lean on.

יְסוֹד

Yesod

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Foundation and integrity: being someone others can truly lean on.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

In a time when trust is at historic lows — in institutions, in each other — being a person others can rely on is not a small thing. Yesod people are the ones communities are built on.

LEARNING TEXT

Yesod means 'Foundation.' Connection is the fruit; Foundation is the root. Yesod is about being someone others can truly lean on: reliable, steady, trustworthy.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

וְצַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם

Ve-tzaddik yesod olam

The righteous one is the foundation of the world. (Proverbs 10:25)

THIS WEEK'S MIDDAH · ■■■■■■

יְסוֹד

Yesod — Connection & Integrity

Practice: This week, keep every promise you make — no matter how small. Let your word be your foundation.

Verse: *The righteous one is the foundation of the world. (Proverbs 10:25)*

Mitzvah Connection: Eilu v'Eilu — honoring connection within community — reminds us that we are part of something larger than ourselves.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"Who is a 'Yesod' in your life — someone who is a steady foundation for you? What makes them that way?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: TRUST CONNECTION

Format: Partner Trust Exercise (2 tasks)

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Click 'Generate Pairs.' Partner facing the board = Leader. Partner facing away = Follower. Display Task 1. Leader guides partner using words only — no touching. Click 'Done!' and switch roles. Repeat for Task 2 (+25 pts each).

Content / Tasks:

• Task 1: "Raise your right hand slowly. Now raise your left. Touch your nose with your right hand, then clap once." (Switch roles after)

• Task 2: "Tap both knees twice. Fold your hands and lift above your head. Bring them back down slowly."

■ What to Look For:

Notice the leaders who give clear, calm instructions — those are the Yesod students. Notice who laughs through nervousness versus who focuses with care for their partner.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Yesod	יְסוֹד	*yeh-SODE*	Foundation; the base on which connection and community rest
Eilu v'Eilu	אֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ	*ay-LOO vah-ay-LOO*	'These and these' — the Talmudic principle honoring diverse valid perspectives
Tzaddik	צַדִּיק	*tzah-DEEK*	A righteous person; one whose life is a foundation for others

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

Sefaria: Proverbs 10:25	sefaria.org/Proverbs.10.25
Chabad.org: Yesod	chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/979464/jewish/Yesod.htm
My Jewish Learning: Honesty and Truth in Jewish Law	myjewishlearning.com/article/honesty-and-truth-in-jewish-law/

WEEK 7 | Omer Day: 49

Leadership through presence: the harvest of 49 days of inner work.

מַלְכוּת

Malchut

1 FACILITATOR OVERVIEW

THE BIG IDEA

Leadership through presence: the harvest of 49 days of inner work.

WHY THIS MATTERS TODAY

Leadership is often portrayed as charisma or authority. Malchut teaches that the deepest leadership is presence — showing up fully with everything you've built inside yourself.

LEARNING TEXT

Malchut is where all seven Sefirot unite: Chesed (kindness), Gevurah (strength), Tiferet (balance), Netzach (endurance), Hod (humility), Yesod (foundation). Shavuot is not something that happens to us — it is the harvest of 49 days of inner work.

2 SPIRITUAL & TRADITIONAL ELEMENTS

WEEKLY QUOTE

מַלְכוּתְךָ מַלְכוּת כָּל עוֹלָמִים

Malkhutekha malkhut kol olamim

Your kingdom is a kingdom of all worlds. (Psalm 145:13)

THIS WEEK'S MIDDAH · ■■■■■■

מַלְכוּת

Malchut — Presence & Leadership

Practice: This week, lead something — even something small. Show up as the version of yourself you've been building all seven weeks.

Verse: *Your kingdom is a kingdom of all worlds. (Psalm 145:13)*

Mitzvah Connection: Teshuvah — returning to your best self — is the ultimate act of Malchut: I am not just what I have done. I am who I am becoming.

4 TALKING POINTS & DISCUSSION

All Grades	"Looking back at all seven Sefirot, which quality do you most want to carry with you? Why?"
Grades 3–5	"Which of the seven big ideas felt most real to you — like something you actually tried? What happened?"
Grades 6–7	"Which Sefirah did you find hardest? What gets in the way of living that quality?"

5 CHALLENGE & GAME: MALCHUT TRIVIA FINALE

Format: 4-Phase Collaborative Finale

Step-by-Step Facilitator Setup:

Navigate to Week 7: Malchut → 'Challenge.' Work through all 7 trivia questions collaboratively. Pause 2 minutes on the Middot Review screen. Read all three commitment options aloud before voting. Click FINISH together — make it a collective moment.

Content / Tasks:

• PHASE 1 — TRIVIA: 7 cumulative questions, one per Sefirah (+25 pts each = 175 pts total).

• PHASE 2 — MIDDOT REVIEW: Visual recap of all 7 Sefirot with Hebrew names and meanings. Pause 2 minutes.

• PHASE 3 — ACTION COMMITMENT: Class votes on: (1) Personal Growth (2) Classroom Impact (3) World Change

• PHASE 4 — GRAND FINALE: 'FINISH YOUR HARVEST JOURNEY' triggers confetti + Arrival at Shavuot (+150 pts).

■ What to Look For:

The Action Commitment vote should feel weighty — don't rush it. Ask: 'Why did we choose this one? What will we do differently next week because of this journey?'

6 EDUCATOR NOTES & DEEP-DIVE CONTEXT

■ EDUCATOR ONLY

Shavuot is celebrated on the 6th and 7th of Sivan. The holiday marks both the giving of the Torah at Sinai and the conclusion of the agricultural barley harvest — the original Omer. Consider connecting the final session to upcoming Shavuot observance in your community.

7 LINGUISTIC REFERENCE

Term	Hebrew	Pronunciation	Meaning
Malchut	מַלְכוּת	*mal-KHOOT*	Kingship; presence; leadership through showing up fully
Teshuvah	תְּשׁוּבָה	*teh-shoo-VAH*	Return; becoming one's best self
Shavuot	שָׁבוּעוֹת	*shah-voo-OTE*	Weeks — the holiday marking the end of the Omer; the giving of the Torah at Sinai
Tzedakah	צְדָקָה	*tzeh-dah-KAH*	Righteousness through giving; justice in action

8 LINKS & RESOURCES

Sefaria: Psalm 145:13	`sefaria.org/Psalms.145`
Chabad.org: Malchut	`chabad.org/library/article_cdo/aid/979465/jewish/Malchut.htm`
My Jewish Learning: Shavuot	`myjewishlearning.com/article/shavuot/`
The iCenter: Teaching Shavuot	`theicenter.org/`